DESIGN DOCUMENT · LANDING PAGE

WORD ON THE WATER

Visual design, responsive layouts, colour palettes and build specification for the ministry's first web page.

Version	Date	Owner	Status
1.0 draft	4 November 2026	Hendrik	For review





01 · OVERVIEW

WHAT THIS DOCUMENT COVERS

This is the single source of truth for designing and building the Word on the Water landing page. It is based on the approved HTML mockup (`landing-page-mockup.html`) and should be read alongside the development plan (`website/CLAUDE.md`).

ITEM	DECISION
Purpose	Introduce the ministry, build an email list before launch, and give first-time visitors a clear way into the gospel.
Audience	Men and surfers of every level, plus people curious about Jesus. Most arrive on a phone from Instagram or email.
Primary action	Subscribe to the weekly devotional.
Secondary actions	Read "Start here", read the statement of faith, send a prayer request.
Palettes	**Dawn patrol** (light, default) and **Night swell** (dark). Other logo schemes are parked.
Devices	Laptop 1440 px, iPad 820 px, mobile 390 px (CSS pixels). Built mobile-first.
Standard	WCAG 2.2 AA accessibility.
Out of scope	Devotional pages, CMS, giving, accounts. These follow in later phases.

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VERSION HISTORY

VERSION	DATE	CHANGE
1.0	4 Nov 2026	First draft from the HTML mockup. Palettes narrowed to Dawn patrol and Night swell.

02 · BRAND FOUNDATIONS

LOGO, VERSE AND VOICE

LOGO MARK (CONCEPT 1B)



A cross standing on the horizon inside a barrelling wave. The horizon line is the cross-beam.

- Built as inline SVG with three colour tokens: `--logo-ring`, `--logo-wave`, `--logo-gap`.
- Minimum size 32 px (header uses 40 px). Below 32 px use the mark without the spray lines.
- Clear space: 25% of the mark's width on all sides.
- Never stretch, rotate, outline, or place on a photo without a solid backing.

ANCHOR VERSE

"Who then is this, that even the wind and the sea obey him?"

MARK 4:41 · ESV

The verse is the thesis of the site and opens the hero. It is always set in Lora italic and is followed by the reference and the tapering curl divider.

ESV copyright notice must appear in the footer on every page (Crossway permission terms).

VOICE

WE ARE	WE AVOID
Plain, like a mate talking	Church jargon and hype
Honest about storms	Easy answers
Rooted in the text	Opinions without Scripture
Welcoming to the curious	Insider language
Short and direct	Long, clever sentences

SURF VOCABULARY USED

Lineup, sets, paddle out, dawn patrol, swell, break, barrel. Use naturally and sparingly, at most once per section.

IMAGERY

Own photography only: early light, empty lineups, boards and wax, hands on a Bible. No stock "praying man" images.

03 · COLOUR PALETTE

DAWN PATROL

LIGHT · DEFAULT

Warm sand and charcoal with a sunrise orange. The light palette, shown when the device is in light mode.

bg	surface	ink	muted
`#FBF3E8` · `--color-bg`	`#FFFAF3` · `--color-surface`	`#2B2D42` · `--color-ink`	`#5C5E70` · `--color-muted`
Page background	Cards, raised areas	Headings, body text	Secondary text

line	accent	accent-ink	deep
`#E9DCCB` · `--color-line`	`#D9703A` · `--color-accent`	`#A9501F` · `--color-accent-ink`	`#2B2D42` · `--color-deep`
Borders, dividers	Decor, dots, numerals, focus	Buttons, links, eyebrows	Hero, subscribe, footer bands

on-deep	on-deep-muted	accent-on-deep
`#FBF3E8` · `--color-on-deep`	`#C4C3CF` · `--color-on-deep-muted`	`#F0955F` · `--color-accent-on-deep`
Text on deep bands	Secondary text on deep	Logo wave, eyebrows on deep

CONTRAST (WCAG 2.2, NORMAL TEXT NEEDS 4.5:1)

- on Body text — AA 12.3
- on Secondary text — AA 5.8
- on Primary button label — AA 5.0
- on Text on deep band — AA 12.3
- on Eyebrow on deep — AA 5.9
- on Text on cards — AA 13.0
- on Links, eyebrows — AA 5.0
- on Accent as text — LARGE ONLY 3.0
- on Muted on deep — AA 7.7
- on Button on deep — AA 12.3



Rule: the orange `accent` (#D9703A) is 3.0:1 on sand, so it is never used for body text or button fills. Buttons and links use `accent-ink` (#A9501F, 4.9:1).

04 · COLOUR PALETTE

NIGHT SWELL

DARK

Deep ocean blue with sea-glass teal and warm white. The dark palette, shown when the device is in dark mode.

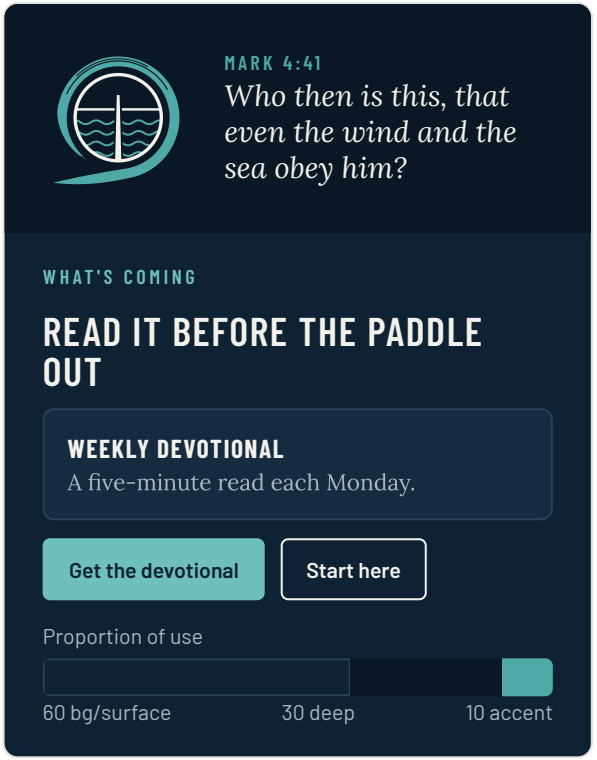
bg	surface	ink	muted
`#0F2233` · `--color-bg`	`#152C40` · `--color-surface`	`#F4F1EA` · `--color-ink`	`#A9B7C2` · `--color-muted`
Page background	Cards, raised areas	Headings, body text	Secondary text

line	accent	accent-ink	deep
`#28425A` · `--color-line`	`#4FA9A6` · `--color-accent`	`#6FC0BC` · `--color-accent-ink`	`#0A1825` · `--color-deep`
Borders, dividers	Decor, dots, numerals, focus	Buttons, links, eyebrows	Hero, subscribe, footer bands

on-deep	on-deep-muted	accent-on-deep
`#F4F1EA` · `--color-on-deep`	`#9FB0BD` · `--color-on-deep-muted`	`#4FA9A6` · `--color-accent-on-deep`
Text on deep bands	Secondary text on deep	Logo wave, eyebrows on deep

CONTRAST (WCAG 2.2, NORMAL TEXT NEEDS 4.5:1)

- on Body text — AA 14.4
- on Secondary text — AA 7.9
- on Primary button label — AA 7.7
- on Text on deep band — AA 15.9
- on Eyebrow on deep — AA 6.5
- on Text on cards — AA 12.7
- on Links, eyebrows — AA 7.7
- on Accent as text — AA 5.8
- on Muted on deep — AA 8.0
- on Button on deep — AA 15.9



Rule: on dark backgrounds the primary button uses `accent-ink` (#6FC0BC) with `bg` text (7.7:1). Avoid pure white; `ink` is a warm off-white that is easier on the eyes at night.

05 · TYPOGRAPHY

THREE FACES, ONE JOB EACH

DISPLAY · BARLOW CONDENSED

PADDLE OUT

Headings, eyebrows, labels. Always uppercase, weights 600–700.

READING · LORA

The sea went still.

Verse, body copy, devotionals. Regular, italic for Scripture.

INTERFACE · BARLOW

Sign me up

Navigation, buttons, forms, captions, legal.

`font-verse`	*Who then is this*	Lora Italic 400 · clamp(30px, 4.4vw, 51px) · lh 1.18
`font-h2`	**READ IT BEFORE THE PADDLE OUT**	Barlow Condensed 600 · clamp(32px, 4.5vw, 44px) · lh 1.05 · +0.04em · uppercase
`font-h3`	**WEEKLY DEVOTIONAL**	Barlow Condensed 600 · 22px · lh 1.05 · +0.05em · uppercase
`font-eyebrow`	WHAT'S COMING	Barlow Condensed 600 · 14px · +0.18em · uppercase · accent-ink
`font-lede`	Short devotionals and plain Bible teaching.	Lora 400 · 18–20px · lh 1.55 · max 52ch
`font-body`	Surfers know the ocean is not tame. Jesus' friends learned that too.	Lora 400 · 17px · lh 1.65 · max 62ch
`font-ui`	About · Devotionals · Start here	Barlow 500/600 · 15px (nav, buttons) · 17px in mobile menu
`font-caption`	Mockup only. Unsubscribe any time.	Barlow 400 · 12.5–13px · lh 1.5

Self-host all three families with `next/font`, Latin subset, `font-display: swap`. Fallbacks: Arial Narrow for display, Georgia for reading, Helvetica Neue/Arial for interface. Body text never goes below 16 px, so iOS does not zoom form fields.

06 · LAYOUT, GRID AND SPACING

A CALM, SINGLE READING COLUMN

CONTAINER AND GRID

RULE	VALUE
Max content width	`1120px`, centred
Side gutter	`max(16px, safe-area-inset)` at every width
Grid	CSS grid, 12-column mental model; sections use 1, 2 or 3 equal columns, or 4 for "Start here"
Column gap	`space-8` 48px (hero), `space-9` 56px (two-column text), `space-5` 20px (cards)
Text measure	62ch for body, 52ch for hero lede
Section rhythm	`space-10` 72px top and bottom; 44px under the hero on mobile
Hero edge	48px wave SVG in `--bg` at the bottom of the hero band

BREAKPOINTS

NAME	MIN WIDTH	DEVICE IN THIS DOCUMENT
`base`	0	Mobile 390
`sm`	640	Large phones, small tablets
`md`	768	iPad portrait 820
`lg`	1024	iPad landscape, small laptops
`xl`	1280	Laptop 1440

These match the Tailwind defaults in the development plan. The mockup's ad hoc points (520, 700, 760, 800, 860) are mapped to them on page 14.

SPACING SCALE

TOKEN	PX	SCALE	TYPICAL USE
`space-1`	4		Icon to label
`space-2`	8		Tight stacks, chip gaps
`space-3`	12		Heading to text
`space-4`	16		Gutter, field gaps
`space-5`	20		Card grid gap
`space-6`	24		Card padding
`space-7`	32		Block spacing
`space-8`	48		Hero column gap
`space-9`	56		Two-column gap
`space-10`	72		Section padding

SHAPE AND DEPTH

TOKEN	VALUE	USE
`radius-sm`	4px	Buttons, inputs, photo
`radius-md`	6px	Cards, sample devotional, notes
`radius-pill`	99px	Status dots, chips
`border`	1px `--line`	Cards, dividers, header bottom
`shadow-menu`	0 12px 24px rgb(0 0 0 / .12)	Mobile menu panel only



07 · PAGE ANATOMY

TEN SECTIONS, ONE STORY

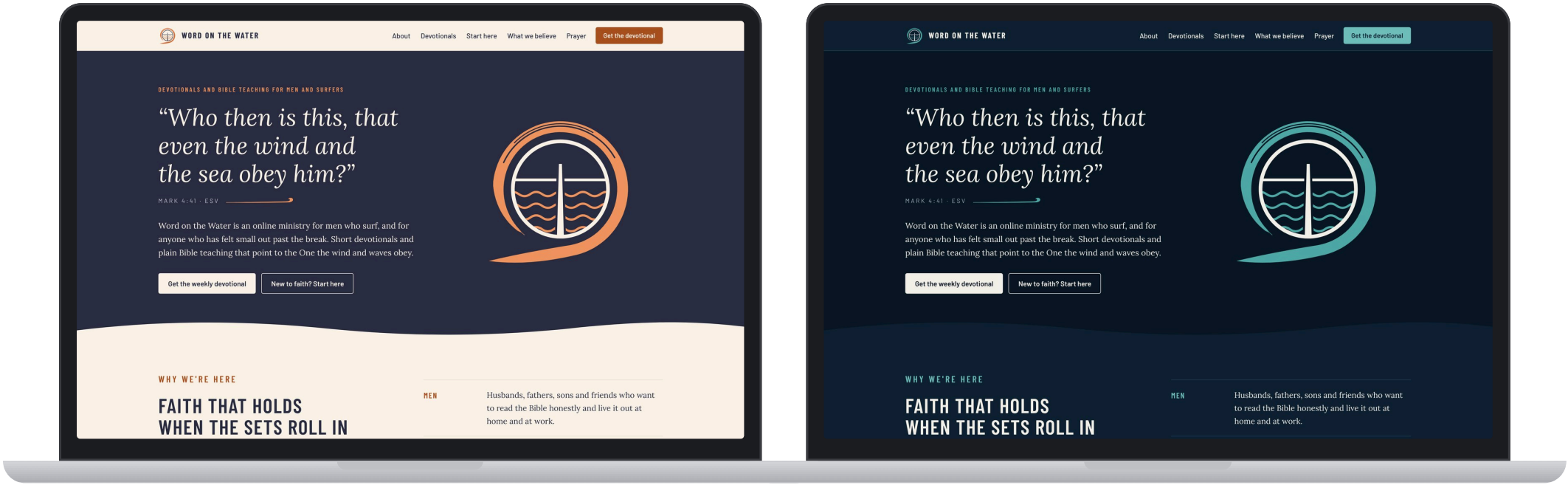
The order follows how a first-time visitor decides: who is this for, what do I get, can I trust it, what do I do next.

1. **Header (sticky).** Logo, five anchor links, "Get the devotional" button. Collapses to a menu button below `lg`.
2. **Hero.** Eyebrow naming the audience, Mark 4:41 as headline, lede, two calls to action, logo mark. Deep band with wave edge.
3. **Why we're here.** Mission in Hendrik's own voice beside a "who it's for" list: men, surfers, the curious.
4. **What's coming.** Three status cards (weekly devotional, teaching series, audio and video).
5. **Sample devotional.** "Today's report" panel styled like a surf report: passage, read time, series, one question. Becomes the devotional template.
6. **Start here.** The gospel in four numbered steps with references, plus "Talk to someone".
7. **What we believe + Meet the writer.** Short statement of faith with link to the full version; founder photo, bio and home church.
8. **Subscribe band.** First name, email, one button. The page's main conversion point.
9. **Prayer and questions.** Two cards with addresses for prayer requests and general contact.
10. **Footer.** Brand and verse, three link groups, ESV notice, copyright and privacy link.

08 · LAPTOP MOCKUPS

LAPTOP · 1440 × 900

Above the fold. Full navigation visible, hero in two columns (text 1.35fr, mark 1fr). Content capped at 1120px so line lengths stay comfortable on wide screens.



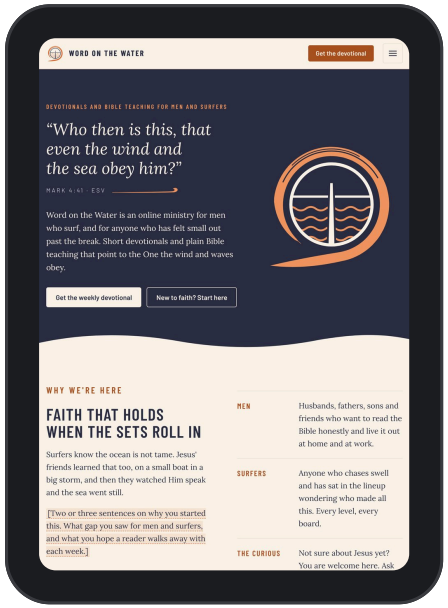
DAWN PATROL
Light · default

NIGHT SWELL
Dark · follows system setting

09 · IPAD MOCKUPS

IPAD AIR · 820 × 1180 PORTRAIT

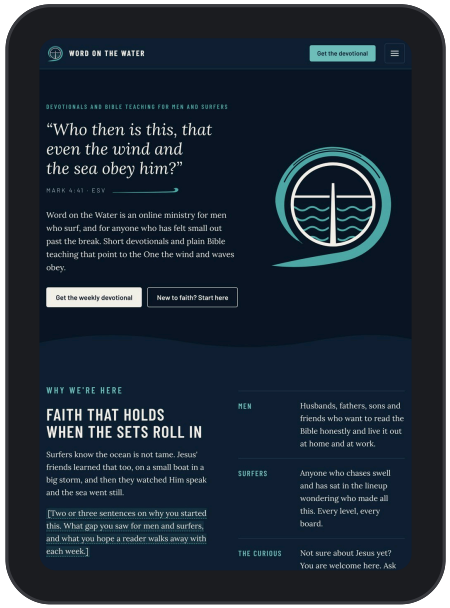
Navigation collapses to the menu button; the header keeps the full "Get the devotional" label. Hero stays two columns, cards stay three across. In landscape (1180) the laptop layout applies.



DAWN · HERO



DAWN · WHAT'S COMING



NIGHT · HERO

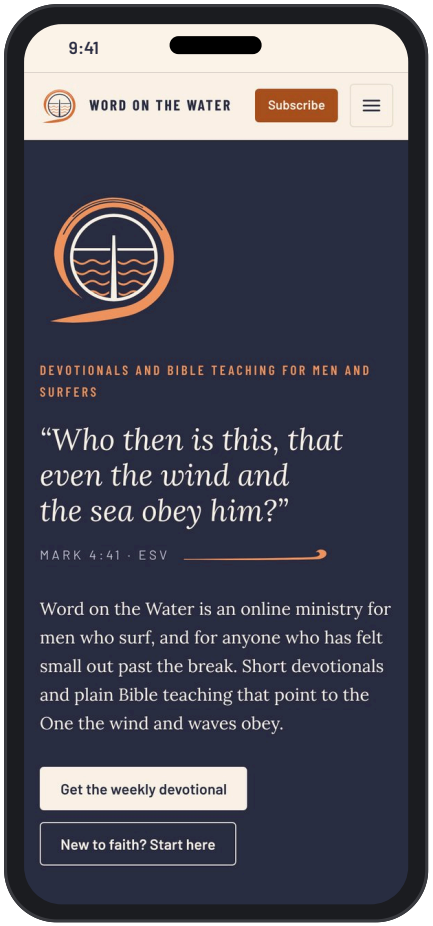


NIGHT · WHAT'S COMING

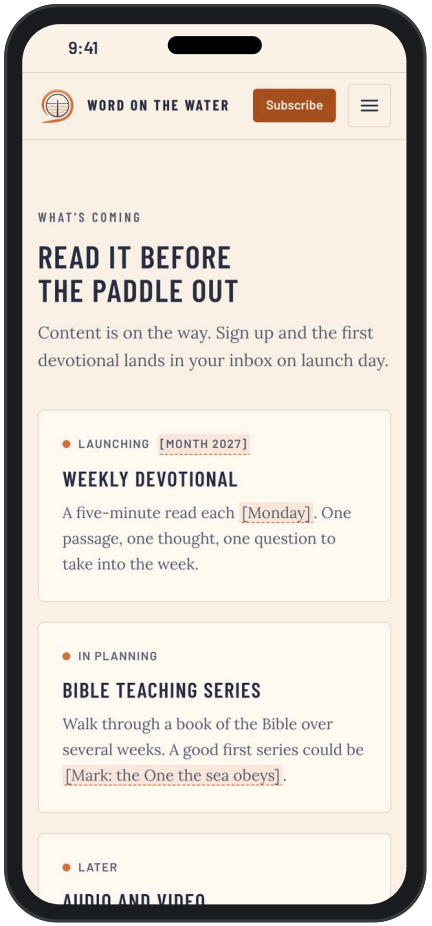
10 · MOBILE MOCKUPS

IPHONE · 390 × 844 · DAWN PATROL

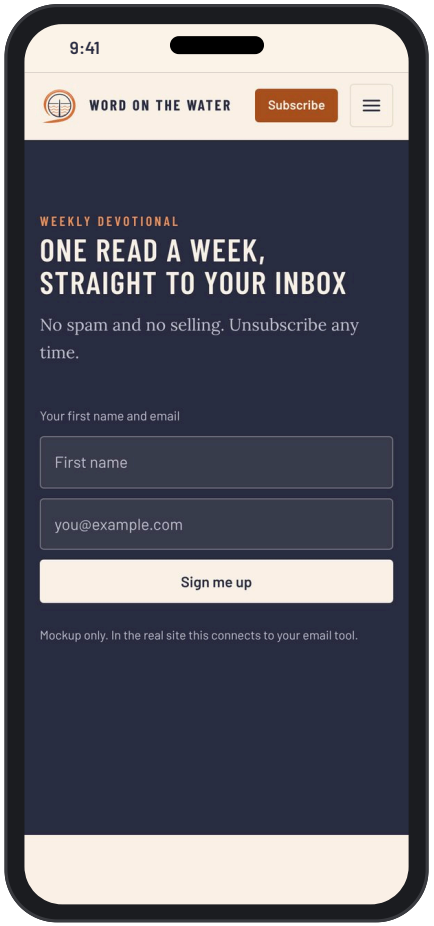
Single column. Logo mark moves above the verse at 150px. Header button shortens to "Subscribe". All tap targets at least 44 × 44 px.



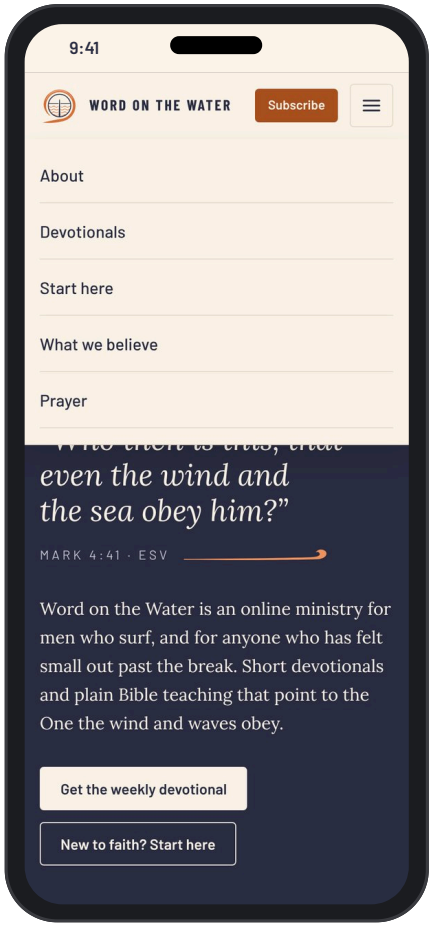
HERO



WHAT'S COMING



SUBSCRIBE

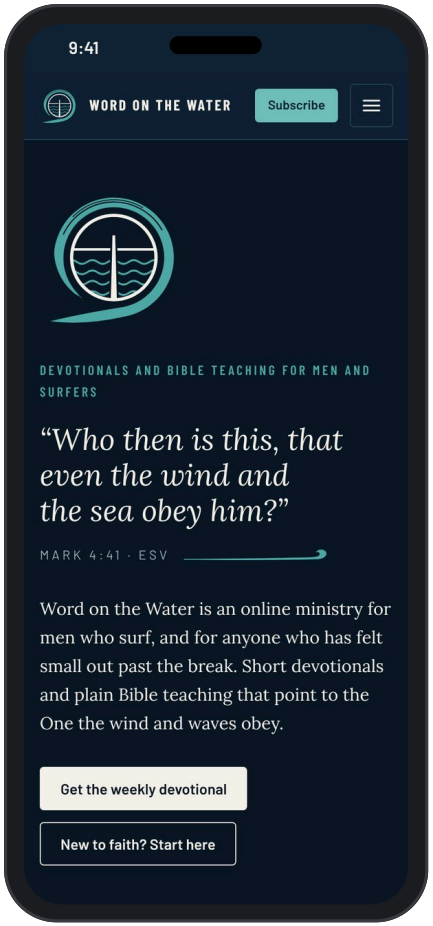


MENU OPEN

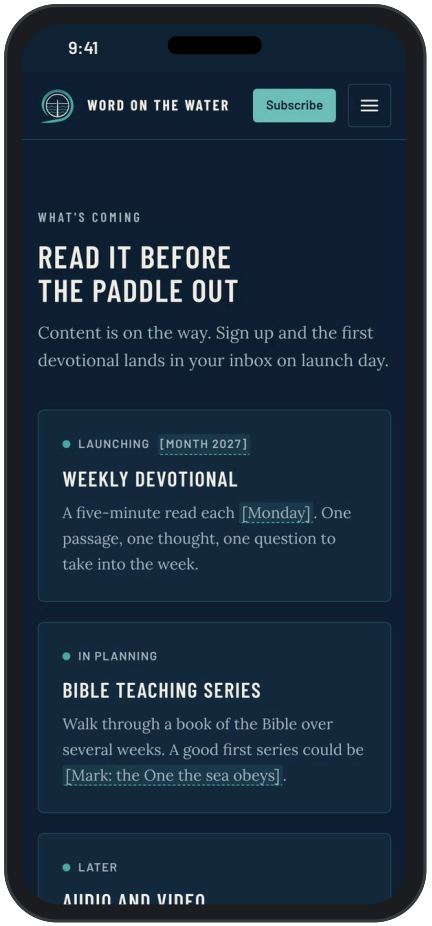
10 · MOBILE MOCKUPS

IPHONE · 390 × 844 · NIGHT SWELL

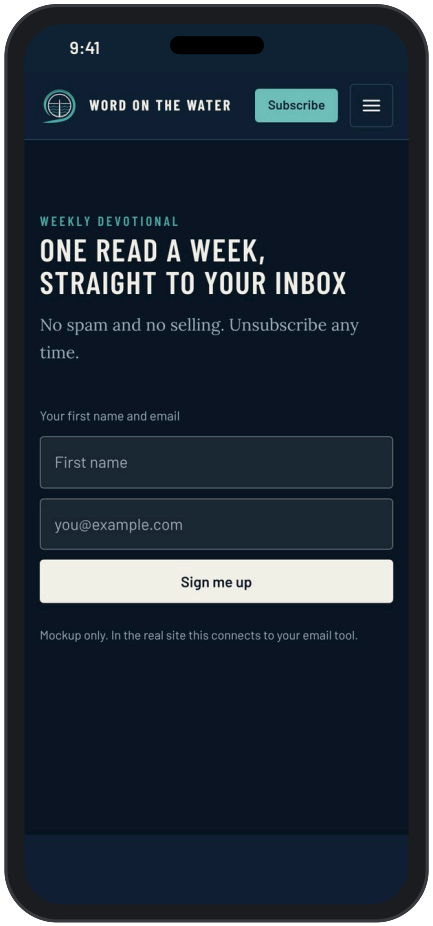
Same layout as Dawn patrol. Only colour tokens change, so both palettes ship from one set of components.



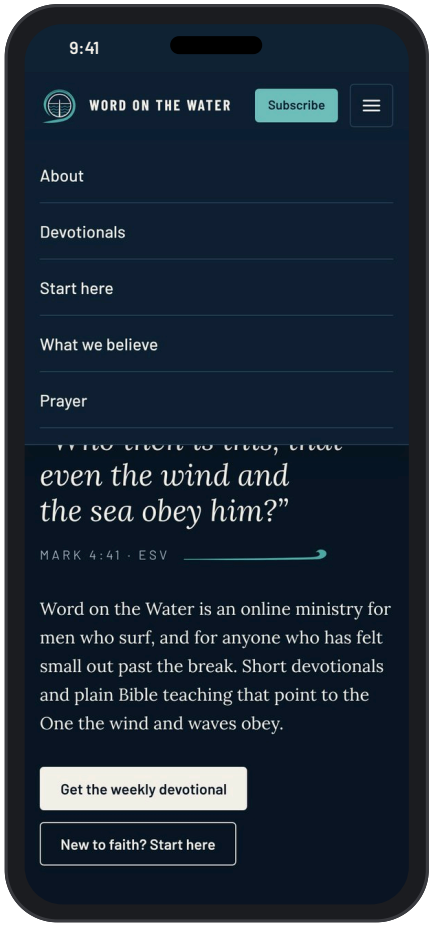
HERO



WHAT'S COMING



SUBSCRIBE

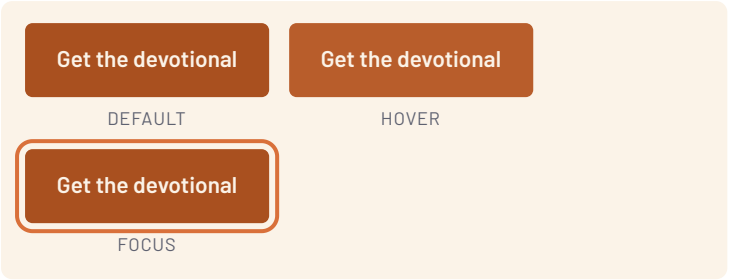


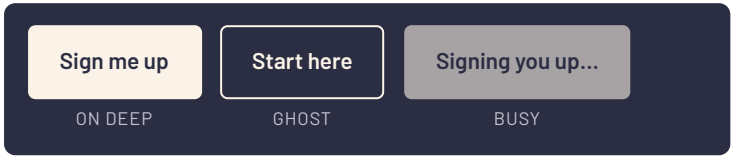
MENU OPEN

11 · COMPONENTS AND STATES

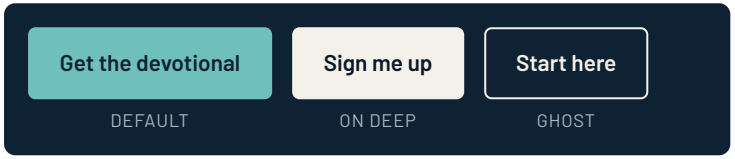
COMPONENTS

BUTTONS · DAWN PATROL





BUTTONS · NIGHT SWELL



EMAIL FIELD



COMPONENT	VARIANTS	SPEC AND STATES
Button	primary, primary-on-deep, ghost	Barlow 600 15px, padding 12/20px (header 9/16px), `radius-sm`, min height 44px. Hover: brightness +8%, 150ms ease-out. Focus: 2px `--accent` outline, 3px offset. Busy: label changes, `aria-busy`, disabled.
Header	full, compact	Sticky, `--bg` fill, 1px bottom border. Compact below `lg`: logo, CTA ("Subscribe" below 520px), 44px menu button.
Menu panel	closed, open	Drops below header, full width, links 17px with 14px vertical padding. Closes on link tap, Esc, or button. Focus returns to the button.
Status card	launching, planning, later	`--surface`, 1px border, `radius-md`, 24px padding. Status: 8px accent dot + 12px uppercase label.
Surf report	sample, live	260px deep panel + body. Rows: passage, read time, series, questions. Values in tabular figures. Stacks below 760px.
Step list	4-up, 2-up, 1-up	Large accent numeral, title, 2-line body, Bible reference in Barlow 13px.
Signup form	idle, invalid, busy, success, error	First name optional, email required. Validate on submit, then on change. Success replaces the form with a message in an `aria-live` region and asks the reader to confirm by email (double opt-in). Server error: "We couldn't sign you up just now. Please try again in a minute."
Placeholder	mockup only	Tinted, dashed underline. Must not ship: a build check fails if any `[…]` placeholder text remains.

12 · RESPONSIVE BEHAVIOUR AND MOTION

HOW THE PAGE ADAPTS

SECTION	MOBILE (BASE, < 768)	IPAD (MD, 768–1023)	LAPTOP (LG / XL, ≥ 1024)	WHY
Header	Logo, "Subscribe", menu button. Wordmark hidden below 360px.	Logo, "Get the devotional", menu button	Full nav with 5 links and CTA	Keeps the main action one tap away at all sizes.
Hero	One column, mark (150px) above eyebrow; buttons stack	Two columns, mark at 40% width	Two columns 1.35fr / 1fr, mark up to 360px	Verse must be visible without scrolling on a phone.
Why we're here	Copy then list; list labels sit above text	One column	Two columns, 56px gap	Avoid narrow text columns on tablets.
What's coming	Cards stacked	Three across	Three across	Short cards stay scannable side by side.
Surf report	Panel above body	Panel beside body	Panel beside body (260px)	
Start here	One step per row (2-up from 520px)	Two by two	Four across	Steps read in order in every layout.
Beliefs + writer	Stacked	Stacked	Two columns	
Subscribe	Heading above form; fields full width	Stacked	Heading and form side by side	Fields need room for long emails.
Footer	Brand full width, link groups two across	Same as mobile	Four columns	

MOTION

ELEMENT	TRIGGER	ANIMATION	DURATION	EASING
Buttons, links	Hover / focus	Colour and brightness	150ms	ease-out
Menu panel	Open / close	Fade + 8px slide down	200ms	cubic-bezier(.2,.8,.2,1)
Anchor links	Click	Smooth scroll, offset by header height	browser	browser
Form success	Submit OK	Message fades in	250ms	ease-out

All motion is removed under `prefers-reduced-motion: reduce`. Nothing on the page starts hidden waiting for an animation.

PALETTE SWITCHING

- Default follows the device: light setting shows Dawn patrol, dark setting shows Night swell.
- A sun/moon toggle in the footer lets readers override. The choice is stored in a cookie so the server renders the right palette with no flash.
- Set `<meta name="theme-color">` per palette (#FBF3E8 / #0F2233) so the phone's browser bar matches.

13 · CONTENT RULES AND EDGE CASES

WRITING TO FIT THE DESIGN

CHARACTER LIMITS

FIELD	LIMIT	IF LONGER
Hero eyebrow	55 characters	Wraps to 2 lines; never more
Hero lede	240 characters	Edit, do not truncate
Section heading (h2)	40 characters	Wraps, balanced
Card title (h3)	28 characters	Wraps to 2 lines
Card body	140 characters	Edit to fit
Devotional title	60 characters	Wraps; no ellipsis
Report values	18 characters	Wraps right-aligned
"Start here" step body	90 characters	Edit to fit
Founder bio	80–100 words	Link to a full About page later
Button labels	3 words	Use a shorter verb phrase

Headlines are never truncated with an ellipsis. Scripture is always quoted in full with its reference.

EDGE CASES

- **No founder photo yet:** show the logo mark on `--surface` in the same 4:5 frame.
- **No launch date:** status reads "Coming soon"; never show a past date.
- **Long names or emails:** fields grow to full width and text scrolls inside the field.
- **Fonts slow to load:** fallbacks render immediately (`swap`); headings must still fit in Arial Narrow.
- **JavaScript off:** the menu falls back to visible links; the form posts as a normal form through the server.
- **Slow connection:** no images above the fold except the inline SVG logo, so the hero renders in the first response.
- **Already subscribed:** show the same success message (do not reveal whether an email is on the list).
- **Duplicate taps:** button disables while busy.
- **Larger text settings:** layout holds at 200% zoom with no sideways scrolling.
- **Other languages later:** allow 30% longer strings; avoid text baked into images.

14 · ACCESSIBILITY

WCAG 2.2 AA FROM DAY ONE

STRUCTURE

- Landmarks: `header`, `nav` (label "Main"), `main`, `footer`.
- One `h1` per page. The hero verse is set as the visual headline; give the page an `h1` of "Word on the Water" (visually hidden if needed) and keep the verse as a `blockquote`.
- Add a "Skip to content" link as the first focusable element. MISSING IN MOCKUP
- Logo: `role="img"` with label "Word on the Water logo"; decorative copies `aria-hidden`.

KEYBOARD AND FOCUS

- Focus order: skip link, logo, nav links (or menu button), header CTA, hero CTAs, then document order.
- Visible focus ring on every interactive element: 2px `--accent`, 3px offset.
- Menu button: `aria-expanded`, `aria-controls`; Esc closes and returns focus.
- Anchor targets get `scroll-margin-top` equal to the header height so headings are not hidden.
- Touch targets at least 44 × 44 px (WCAG 2.5.8 asks for 24).

FORMS AND ANNOUNCEMENTS

- Every field has a visible label tied with `for`.
- Errors: text below the field, linked with `aria-describedby`, field gets `aria-invalid="true"`, focus moves to the first error.
- Success and server errors are announced from an `aria-live="polite"` region.
- Inputs are 16px or larger so iOS does not zoom.
- Prayer requests: explain who reads them and how they are kept private, next to the form.

> Contrast for every text and background pair is listed on the palette pages (4 and 5). The one pair that fails, Dawn patrol `--accent` #D9703A as text on sand (3.0:1), is reserved for large decorative use only. Buttons and links use `--accent-ink` instead. Test with axe in CI, then a manual pass with VoiceOver on iPhone and TalkBack on Android before launch.

15 · OPEN QUESTIONS AND NEXT STEPS

DECISIONS STILL NEEDED

#	QUESTION	ASSUMPTION IN THIS DOCUMENT
1	Should Dawn patrol be the light palette and Night swell the dark one, switching with the device setting?	Yes, with a manual toggle in the footer
2	Final logo artwork as a clean SVG from a designer?	Mockup SVG is a close redraw of concept 1b
3	Domain and email addresses (hello@, prayer@)	Placeholders shown
4	Who reads and answers prayer requests, and how quickly?	Hendrik, within 3 days
5	Statement of faith: own wording or adopt an existing creed?	Short summary plus link
6	Day and time for the weekly devotional	Monday
7	Photography: who shoots the founder and surf images?	Placeholders until shot

NEXT STEPS

- Hendrik reviews this document and answers the questions above.
- Write the real copy for every `[placeholder]` using the limits on page 15.
- Pastor or elder reads "Start here" and the statement of faith.
- Turn the tokens on pages 4–7 into `tokens.css` for the Next.js build.
- Build the landing page (Phase 1 of the development plan) and test on a real iPhone, iPad and laptop.

SIGN-OFF

ROLE	NAME	DATE
Ministry lead	Hendrik	
Theological review		